

7 For the vineyard of the LORD of hosts is the house of Israel, and the men of Judah are the plant of his delight: and he hoped for justice, but behold injustice; for equity, but behold iniquity.*

8 ¶ Wo unto those that cause house to join on house, bring field near^o to field, till there is no more room, so that ye may be left alone as the inhabitants in the midst of the land!

9 In my ears (spoke) the LORD of hosts, Truly many houses shall become desolate, yea, great and beautiful ones without an inhabitant.

10 Yea, ten acres of vineyard shall yield (but) one bath, and a chomer-seed^d shall yield (but) an ephah.

11 ¶ Wo unto those that rise up early in the morning, that they may run after strong drink; that continue until late in the twilight, till wine inflame them!

12 And there are harp and psaltery, tambourine and flute, and wine at their drinking-feasts; but the deeds of the LORD they regard not, and the works of his hands they behold not.

13 Therefore are my people led into exile, for want of knowledge;^a and their honourable men suffer of famine, and their multitude are panting with thirst.

14 Therefore hath the deep^e enlarged her desire, and opened her mouth without measure: and there descend (Jerusalem's)^f glory, and her multitude, and her noise, and who ever rejoiced therein.

15 And bent down shall be the son of earth, and humbled shall be the man, and the eyes of the lofty shall be humbled;

16 And the LORD of hosts shall be exalted in judgment, and the holy God shall be sanctified by (displaying his) righteousness.

17 Then shall the sheep feed according to

their wont, and the ruins of the fat ones shall sojourners eat.

18 ¶ Wo unto those that draw iniquity with the cords of falsehood, and as with a wagon-rope, sinfulness;

19 That say, Let him make speed, let him hasten his work, that we may see it: and let draw nigh and come the counsel of the Holy One of Israel, that we may know it!

20 ¶ Wo unto those that say of the evil it is good, and of the good it is evil; that put darkness for light, and light for darkness; that put bitter for sweet, and sweet for bitter!

21 ¶ Wo unto those that are wise in their own eyes, and intelligent in their own esteem!^g

22 ¶ Wo unto those that are heroes to drink wine, and men of might to mingle strong drink;

23 Who justify the wicked in lieu of a bribe, and who deprive the righteous of their right!

24 ¶ Therefore as the tongue of the fire devoureth the stubble, and dry hay sinketh before the flame: so shall their root be as rotten things, and their blossom shall fly up as the dust: because they have despised the law of the LORD of hosts, and the word of the Holy One of Israel they have rejected.

25 For this cause is kindled the anger of the LORD against his people, and he stretcheth^h forth his hand against them, and he smiteth them; and the mountains tremble, and their carcases lie like sweepingsⁱ in the midst of the streets: with all this his anger is not turned away, but still is his hand stretched out.

26 And he will lift up an ensign to the nations from afar, and will call^k for one of them from the end of the earth; and, behold, with speed, swiftly, it cometh;

* Lit. "outcry," i. e. against the false decrees of the judges. It has been endeavored to retain the play on the words in the original, משפט against משפט, and צדקה against צדקה.

^b i. e. "By taking away by force the intermediate property."

^c A chomer is ten ephahs or ten baths.

^d רעת is rendered by Sachs "unawares;" i. e. before they are aware or knowing of the evil. We have followed Rashi and Jonathan, who also give רעת with "dying of famine."

^e שואל is rendered *hall* in the English version; but the

general idea is the place where the dead go to, "the grave," "the deep," "the nether world."

^f After Rashi.

^g Heb. "and in the presence of their face."

^h In the Hebrew the past tense is used, because to the prophet's eyes the present is already past.

ⁱ After Rashi. But Aben Ezra takes the כסא of כסא belonging to the root, and renders, "shall be cast away." Redak, "cut in pieces."

^k Lit. "whistle," or "pipe." Rashi, "Sijleer, which is also a sign for gathering, like the lifting up of the banner."

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27 There is none weary nor stumbling among its men; it slumbereth not, it sleepeth not; not loosened is the girdle of its loins, not broken is the latchet of its shoes;

28 Whose arrows are sharpened, and all whose bows are bent; its horses hoofs are hard like the flint, and its wheels like the whirlwind;

29 It hath a roar like the lioness, it roareth like the young lions: yea, it growleth, and layeth hold of the prey, and carrieth it safely off, with none to deliver.

30 And it will rage against them on that day like with the raging of the sea: and if one look unto the earth, behold, there is darkness, oppression,^a and the light is darkened through the darkness of its clouds.

CHAPTER VI.

1 ¶ In the year of king 'Uzziah's death I saw the Lord sitting upon a high and exalted throne, and his train filled the temple.

2 Seraphim were standing around him, each one had six wings; with two he covered his face, and with two he covered his feet, and with two did he fly.

3 And one called unto the other, and said, Holy, holy, holy is the LORD of hosts; the whole earth is full of his glory.

4 And the posts of the threshold shook at the voice of those that called aloud, and the house was filled with smoke.

5 And I said, Wo is me! for I am lost; because a man of unclean lips am I, and in the midst of a people of unclean lips do I dwell; for the King, the LORD of hosts have my eyes seen.

6 Then flew unto me one of the seraphim, and in his hand was a live coal,^c with the tongs had he taken it from off the altar:

7 And he touched therewith upon my mouth, and said, Lo, this hath touched thy lips; and thy iniquity is departed, and thy sin is forgiven.

8 And I heard the voice of the Lord, say-

^a i. e. The inimical nation, against Israel.

^b Sachs, "darkness of distress," otherwise this verse is rendered after him. Some translate, "moon and sun are rendered dark through its clouds;" making נֶחֱמָה the moon, or small luminary.

^c Sachs, "a glowing stone."

^d Philippon, "You shall hear, but not understand," &c.

^e After Rashi. Others, "Make obdurate," &c.; meaning, the perverseness of the people is so great that the

ing, Whom shall I send, and who will go for us? And I said, Here am I; send me.

9 And he said, Go, and say unto this people, Hear^a indeed, but understand not; and see indeed, but know not.

10 Obdurate^a will remain the heart of this people, and their ears will be heavy, and their eyes will be shut: so that they will not see with their eyes, nor hear with their ears, nor their hearts be understanding, so that they be converted, and healing be granted them.

11 And I said, How long, O Lord? And he said, Until that cities be left waste without an inhabitant, and houses without man, and the soil be made desolate as a wilderness.

12 And the LORD will have removed far away the men, and the depopulation be great in the midst of the land.

13 And should a tenth part thereof yet remain, it will again be swept away: (yet) like the terebinth and the oak, which, when they cast their leaves, retain their stems, so remaineth the holy seed, its^a stem.

CHAPTER VII.

1 ¶ And it came to pass in the days of Achaz the son of Jotham, the son of 'Uzziah, the king of Judah, that Rezin the king of Syria, and Pekach the son of Remalyahu, the king of Israel, went up toward Jerusalem to war against it; but were not able to make an attack upon it.

2 And it was told unto the house^a of David, saying, Syria is encamped with Ephraim; and his heart trembled, with the heart of his people, as the trees of the forest are shaken before the wind.

3 ¶ And the LORD said unto Isaiah, Go forth now to meet Achaz, thou with Sheâr-yashub thy son, to the end of the aqueduct of the upper pool, on the highway of the washer's^b field;

4 And thou shalt say unto him, Take heed, and be quiet; fear not, and let thy heart not become faint because of these two stumps of smoking firebrands, before the fierce

prophetic mission will only display the stronger their unworthiness. (See Exod. iii. 19; Deut. xxix. 3.)

^a Israel's. The deciduous tree casts its leaves in the autumn; still it dies not; with return of the spring a new foliage appears; so, though destruction comes after destruction over the godless, the holy seed, the truly pious, are the stem, the trunk of Israel's tree, sending out new branches and new leaves for ever.

^b i. e. The king.

^c Others, "fuller's field."

anger of Rezin with Syria, and of the son of Remalyahu.

5 Forasmuch as Syria, (with) Ephraim and the son of Remalyahu, have taken evil counsel against thee, saying,

6 Let us go up against Judah, and besiege^a it, and let us make a breach therein for us, and set up as king in the midst of it the son of Tabeal:

7 ¶ Thus hath said the Lord Eternal, It shall not succeed, and it shall not come to pass.

8 For the head of Syria is Damascus, and the head of Damascus is Rezin: and within sixty and five^b years shall Ephraim be broken, to be no more a people.

9 And the head of Ephraim is Samaria, and the head of Samaria is Remalyahu's son. If ye will not believe, surely ye shall not have permanence.

10 ¶ And the LORD continued to speak unto Achaz, saying,

11 Ask thee a sign from the LORD thy God; ask it in the depth, or high up above.

12 But Achaz said, I will not ask, and I will not tempt the LORD.

13 And he said, Hear ye now, O house of David! Is it too little for you to weary men, that ye will weary also my God?

14 Therefore will the Lord himself give you a sign: behold, this young^c woman shall conceive, and bear a son, and she^d shall call his name Immanu-el, (God with us.)

15 Cream^e and honey shall he eat, so soon as he knoweth to refuse the evil, and to choose the good.

16 For before yet the child shall know to refuse the evil, and to choose the good, shall be forsaken the land, of the kings of which thou feelest dread.

17 The LORD will bring over thee, and over thy people, and over thy father's house, days that have not come, from the day that Ephraim withdrew from Judah,—the king of Assyria.

18 ¶ And it shall come to pass on that day, that the LORD will call^f for the fly that is in the uttermost end of the streams of Egypt, and for the bee that is in the land of Assyria.

19 And they shall come, and shall encamp, all of them, in the desolate valleys, and in the clefts of the rocks, and upon all thorn-hedges, and upon all bushes.

20 On the same day will the Lord shave with the razor that is hired, from among those on the other side of the river, with the king of Assyria,^g the head, and the hair of the feet: and also the beard shall it entirely remove.

21 ¶ And it shall come to pass on that day, that a man shall nourish (but) one young cow,^h and two sheep;

22 And it shall happen, that for the abundance of milk which they shall give he shall eat cream; for cream and honey shall eat every one that is left in the midst of the land.

23 And it shall come to pass on that day, that every place, where there are (now) a thousand vines worth a thousand silver shekels, shall be,—yea, this shall be (given up) to briars and thorns.

24 With arrows and with bows shall men enter thither; because all the land shall become (covered with) briars and thorns.

25 And all mountains that are worked with the mattock, thereⁱ shall not come thither the fear of briars and thorns: and they shall serve for the pasture of oxen, and for the treading of sheep.

CHAPTER VIII.

1 ¶ And the LORD said unto me, Take thyself a large table,^k and write on it with distinct letters,^l Lemaher-shalal-chash-bas.^m

2 And I was to summon for myself trustworthy witnesses, Uriyah the priest, and Zecharyahu the son of Yeberech-yahu.

3 And I came near unto the prophetess;

war; but this shall cease speedily and there be plenty for all.ⁿ

^f Lit. "whistle." (See above, v. 26.)

^g The Assyrian is the razor which is to do God's bidding.

^h Rashi, "after the desolation, and on the little that is left will I send my blessing."

ⁱ Philippon, "thou shalt not enter there for fear of briars and thistles."

^k Jonathan. Rashi, "roll."

^l Jonathan; lit. "the pen," "or style of a man."

^m i. e. Speedy booty, sudden spoil.

^a Philippon, "inclose." Sachs, "trouble."

^b Rashi refers this to the prophecy of Amos from which the period is to be dated to which Isaiah now refers; and to this he properly appends a sign, Achaz having no doubt shown that he believed Isaiah as little as the older prophet Amos.

^c ערלה does not necessarily signify *virgin*, but a young marriageable woman in general. (See also Prov. xxx. 21.)

^d Others, "and thou shalt call," addressing the young woman herself.

^e Rashi, who comments, "Now all is desolate by the